

» SUNDAR SINGH GURJAR

Category: Athletics (Men's Javelin Throw F46)

Sundar Singh Gurjar transitioned to para-sports after his left hand was amputated in 2015 following an accident when a tin roof fell on him. At the 2024 Paris Paralympics, he replicated his Tokyo bronze medal, becoming a two-time Paralympic medallist.

Hailing from Rajasthan, Sundar competes in the men's javelin F46 category, which is for athletes with arm or hand impairments, such as above- or below-elbow amputations.

Despite losing his hand and battling depression, Sundar persevered, qualifying for the Rio 2016 Paralympics but was disqualified after missing the roll call. However, he bounced back and won three gold medals in javelin, shot put, and discus throw at the 2017 FAZZA IPC Athletics Grand Prix in Dubai.

In 2022, Sundar set a world record at the Asian Para Games in Hangzhou with a throw of 68.60 metres, after securing silver in the previous edition. He also earned a bronze in discus throw F46 in Jakarta.



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» KAPIL PARMAR

Category: Blind Judo (Men's -60kg J1)

Kapil Parmar made history as the first Indian to win a Paralympic medal in judo, clinching bronze in the men's -60kg J1 category at the 2024 Paris Paralympics.

Hailing from Shivor village in Madhya Pradesh, Kapil's life changed drastically after a near-fatal electrocution accident as a child, which left him in a coma for six months and severely affected his vision.

At his lowest point, Kapil found solace in blind judo. He shifted to Lucknow to train at the Indian Blind and Para Judo Academy, where he began to make a name for himself. In 2019, he won his first international medal at the Commonwealth Championships in Birmingham, followed by several accolades at IBSA Judo Grand Prix events. He won silver at the 2022 Asian Para Games and gold at the IBSA Judo Grand Prix in Tbilisi earlier this year.

Kapil also had to endure financial hardships in his journey. At one point, he and his brother Lalit had to run a tea stall to support his passion for judo. And now, his perseverance has paid off on the world stage.